

HOW LEARNING GROWS:

VERTICAL & HORIZONTAL ALIGNMENT

MADE SIMPLE

THE BIG IDEA

At its core...

Vertical = growth over time

Horizontal = connection across learning

Ask yourself... "Where has this learning come from... and where is it going next?"



THE GARDEN METAPHOR

Vertical alignment is how a plant grows taller over time.

Horizontal alignment is how everything in the garden connects—soil, water, sunlight.

Think: Growth + Connection = Strong Learning

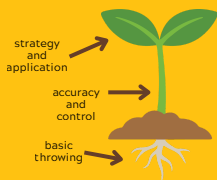


VERTICAL ALIGNMENT

Learning builds over time.

So what students learn this year prepares them for next year. In PE this might look like:

- Grade 2: basic throwing
- Grade 3: accuracy + control
- Grade 4: strategy + application

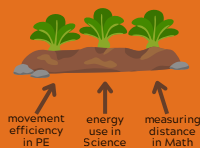


HORIZONTAL ALIGNMENT

Learning also connects across subjects

So what students learn in PE links with other learning subject and areas:

- PE - movement efficiency
- Science - energy use
- Math - measuring distance



WHY IT MATTERS

Strong learning grows up—and connects across. It...

- Ensures learning builds logically over time
- Reduces gaps and unnecessary overlap
- Strengthens connections across disciplines
- Promotes deeper understanding and application
- Helps students make sense of their learning journey



THE
SEED LAB

SUPPORTING EDUCATORS
IN EFFECTIVE DEVELOPMENT

"Without strong roots and steady growth... learning struggles to thrive."
The SEED Lab - Supporting Educators in Effective Development